ACME TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

EMPLOYEE LEAVE POLICY

HR Operational Guideline

DOCUMENT ID	EFFECTIVE DATE	DEPARTMENT	TARGET AUDIENCE
POL-LVE-2026-V3	January 1, 2026	Human Resources	All India Employees

1. POLICY OVERVIEW

Acme Technologies Pvt. Ltd. believes that time away from work is essential for employee health, productivity, and personal life balance. This policy outlines statutory and company-provided leave entitlements, accrual rules, and approval workflows.

2. ANNUAL LEAVE SUMMARY

Leave Category	Annual Entitlement	Accrual Frequency	Carry-Forward Ceiling
Annual / Earned Leave	**24 Days**	2.0 days credited per completed month	Maximum 10 days carried into next calendar year
Sick / Medical Leave	**12 Days**	1.0 day credited per completed month	Non-cumulative (expires Dec 31 annually)
Parental Leave	**16 Weeks**	Lump-sum upon qualifying event	Must be utilized within 1 year of birth/adoption
Casual / Personal Leave	**6 Days**	0.5 days credited per completed month	Non-cumulative (expires Dec 31 annually)

3. DETAILED LEAVE CATEGORIES

3.1 Annual Leave (Earned Leave)

Annual Leave is designed for rest, vacation, and extended personal commitments.

- **Accrual:** Employees earn 2 days per month. Newly hired staff accrue leave on a pro-rata basis during their first calendar year.
- **Carry-Over & Encashment:** A maximum of 10 unused Annual Leave days can be carried over into the next calendar year. Excess days above 10 are forfeited automatically unless encashment is explicitly requested. Encashment is calculated based on Base Salary.
- **Block Leave Requirement:** Employees are encouraged to take at least one continuous block of 5 consecutive days of Annual Leave per year.

3.2 Sick Leave

Sick Leave provides paid coverage for personal illness, medical appointments, or injury.

- **Medical Certificate Requirement:** If Sick Leave extends beyond **3 consecutive working days**, a certified doctor's medical certificate must be uploaded to the HR portal upon return.
- Sick leave cannot be converted into cash encashment at any time.

3.3 Parental Leave Framework

Acme Technologies provides generous paid parental leave to support new parents welcoming a child through birth or adoption.

Parental Category	Duration Entitlement	Key Eligibility & Stipulations
Primary Caregiver (Maternity/Primary)	**16 Weeks** fully paid	Applies to biological mothers and primary adoptive parents. Can begin 4 weeks prior to expected delivery.
Secondary Caregiver (Paternity/Secondary)	**4 Weeks** fully paid	Applies to non-primary caregivers. Must be taken within 6 months of delivery or adoption placement.

4. PUBLIC HOLIDAYS SCHEDULE (2026 CALENDAR YEAR)

The company provides **10 paid public holidays** per calendar year. The official list for 2026 includes:

- **Republic Day:** January 26, 2026 (Monday)
- **Holi:** March 4, 2026 (Wednesday)
- **Good Friday:** April 3, 2026 (Friday)
- **Independence Day:** August 15, 2026 (Saturday)
- **Mahatma Gandhi Jayanti:** October 2, 2026 (Friday)
- **Dussehra:** October 20, 2026 (Tuesday)
- **Diwali:** November 8, 2026 (Sunday)
- **Christmas Day:** December 25, 2026 (Friday)
- **2 Optional/Restricted Holidays:** Chosen from the annual company optional holiday list.

5. LEAVE APPLICATION & APPROVAL PROCESS

To ensure smooth operational continuity, leave requests must be submitted through the **Acme Workday HR Portal** following these advance notice timelines:

1. **Short Leave (1–2 Days):** Submit at least 24 hours in advance via the portal.
2. **Extended Annual Leave (3+ Days):** Submit at least 2 weeks in advance for Manager approval.
3. **Parental Leave:** Submit notice at least 6 weeks prior to the anticipated start date.

> **Approval Workflow Note**
> Requests are automatically routed to the direct manager. If a manager does not act within 48 business hours, the system escalates the request to the Department HR Business Partner.

6. LEAVE ELIGIBILITY & GENERAL RULES

- **Probation Rules:** Employees on probation may access accrued Sick Leave immediately, but Annual Leave can only be taken after 3 months of continuous service.
- **Sandwich Rule:** Weekends or public holidays falling within an active leave period are *not* counted as leave days (Non-sandwich policy).
- **Unauthorized Absence:** Taking leave without prior approval or exceeding approved leave without extension will be treated as Leave Without Pay (LWP) and may trigger disciplinary action.